FIVE TORCHES DEEP: HOUSE RULES

Updated Nov 2, 2026 · Shiv

House rules for our level-9 Five Torches Deep campaign. The first sections change core character creation; the rest add veteran traits, Wisdom of Age, and ailments. Anything not covered here plays as core FTD, including its disease, fatigue, and exhaustion rules.

Level 9, no XP

PCs start at level 9, the FTD cap, and never level up. Characters change through the story instead: new legends, upgrades to Old Faithful, and the optional worsening rule (a new ailment for +1 to an ability score).

Quick build (about 30 minutes, or use the Veteran Forge)

1. Roll ability scores, assign them, and add racial boosts.
2. Pick race, class, and archetype.
3. HP: your class's starting HP at level 1, then the class die's average (rounded up) for levels 2–9, adding CON mod each level.
4. Apply every level-up gain through level 9 from your class table.
5. Add veteran traits, Wisdom of Age, and two ailments.

Multiclassing

You may split your 9 levels between two classes (for example Warrior 5 / Zealot 4). Core FTD has no multiclassing; these rules are ours. The Veteran Forge builds it under step 3.

Area	Rule
HP	First class's starting HP, then each class's hit die for its remaining levels (Warrior 5 / Zealot 4: d10 × 4, d8 × 4).
Class abilities	Each class's table up to its own level. Nothing above that level, so no Warrior third attack below Warrior 9.
Ability +1s	One for each 4th, 6th and 8th level a class reaches (Warrior 5 / Zealot 4 gets two).
Archetype abilities	Only from slots each class reaches: its 3rd and 7th level. A human's extra pick goes to the first class's archetype.
"Per level" text	Means that class's level, not 9. A Zealot 4's heal is 4d6.
Spellcasting	One spellcasting class at most (no Zealot + Mage). You cast at that class's level, and "/lvl" in spell text means that level. Proficiency stays +4.
Proficiencies	Armor and weapons from both classes. A feature that grants what you already have (Martial proficiency on a Warrior) is wasted; pick another.
Starting kit	The first class's only.

Open question: spell levels by caster level. The tool assumes half the class level, rounded up (Zealot 4 casts levels 1–2), all known. Check against the rulebook's table.

Ability scores

Roll six scores, place them in any order across STR, DEX, CON, INT, WIS and CHA, then add the race's boosts. Class minimums (13+) are checked after boosts. Modifiers keep climbing past 18: 18–19 is +4, 20–21 is +5, 22–23 is +6.

Race	Roll each score	Boosts	Racial traits
Human	4d6, drop the lowest	+2 to one ability of your choice	None; picks 3 archetype class abilities instead of 2
Dwarf	4d6, drop the lowest	+2 CON, +2 STR	Pick 2 of 6
Elf	4d6, drop the lowest	+2 DEX, +2 INT	Pick 2 of 6
Halfling	4d6, drop the lowest	+2 WIS, +2 CHA	Pick 2 of 6

Racial traits

FTD races have no abilities of their own, so dwarves, elves, and halflings each pick 2 traits from their race's list, adapted from classic D&D. Humans get a third archetype class ability instead.

Race	Trait	Effect
Dwarf	Darksight	See in darkness out to 60 ft as if it were dim light.
Dwarf	Dwarven Resilience	Advantage on checks against poison; poison damage you take is halved.
Dwarf	Stonecunning	Advantage on checks about stonework, mining, and underground direction. You can't get lost underground.
Dwarf	Dwarven Toughness	+1 HP per level (+9 HP at level 9).

Race	Trait	Effect
Dwarf	Armor-Bred	Heavy armor gives you no disadvantage on stamina checks and counts as 4 load.
Dwarf	Axe and Hammer Training	Proficient with the hatchet, war axe, warhammer, and lumber axe whatever your class.
Elf	Darksight	See in darkness out to 60 ft as if it were dim light.
Elf	Keen Senses	Advantage on sight and listening checks.
Elf	Fey Ancestry	Advantage against charm effects; magic can't put you to sleep.
Elf	Trance	Four hours of trance give a full night's rest, so you can keep watch and still rest.
Elf	Elven Weapon Training	Proficient with the arming sword, longsword, hunting bow, and war bow whatever your class.
Elf	Elven Cantrip	Know one arcane cantrip, cast with INT and no check.
Halfling	Lucky	When you roll a natural 1 on a d20 check, reroll it once and use the new roll.
Halfling	Brave	Advantage against fear effects.
Halfling	Nimble	Move through the space of any creature larger than you; advantage to escape a grapple.
Halfling	Naturally Stealthy	Hide behind a creature larger than you, with advantage on that stealth check.
Halfling	Stout Resilience	Advantage on checks against poison; poison damage you take is halved.
Halfling	Sure Shot	+1 to attack with thrown weapons, slings, and hunting bows.

Retainers and magic items

- **Retainers:** a PC's maximum followers equals their CHA modifier (0 if it is 0 or less), replacing FTD's CHA score limit. At level 9 every one of them is a hench: 3 HD, loyal, no wages. Roll 1d4 for each one's type: 1 Laborer, 2 Expert, 3 Militia, 4 Adept. Reroll on the sheet until you like the mix; names can wait until play.
- **Magic items:** there is no limit on how many magic items a PC can use. FTD's CHA-mod limit is dropped.

Veteran traits

Every PC gets all four.

Trait	Rule
Old Faithful	Your signature and reasonably mythic magic item from your glory days. Name it and describe its properties, then agree them with your GM. It is never lost or broken unless you choose a dramatic moment for it.
Legend	Once per session, invoke your reputation: advantage on one social check. The GM may have someone recognize you at the worst moment, too.
Broke	You're broke: start with no coin. Say where all your gold went.
Rust	Every class ability starts rusty. Using one needs a DC 12 check with its closest ability score to get back in the saddle; fail and it doesn't work or only partly works (GM's call). One success clears the flag.

How ailments work

Each PC takes two ailments; playing them well earns Grit tokens.

- **Choosing:** roll d100 twice on the table below or pick two.
- **Triggers are narrow:** an ailment only applies when its trigger happens. No standing penalties.
- **Flare-up:** once per session per PC, the GM may invoke an ailment outside its trigger when the fiction supports it. The player can refuse by paying a Grit token.
- **Earning Grit:** the GM awards a token when a player roleplays an ailment so it shapes the scene, or powers through it (takes the penalty and pushes on anyway). An ailment that just applies its penalty earns nothing.
- **Grit token:** spend to reroll any d20 you just rolled, or to add 1d6 to an ally's check as you bark advice. Hold a maximum of 2. Tokens don't carry between sessions.
- **Worsening (optional):** after a near-death moment, the GM may offer a third ailment in exchange for +1 to an ability score of the player's choice.

Ailments table (d100)

Each ailment ties to something FTD already tracks (light, supply, spellcasting checks, actions), so it bites without new subsystems.

d100	Ailment	Category	Trigger	Effect
1	Bad Knee	Joints & Bones	Climbing, jumping, or running more than a round	Disadvantage on the check. After a long march, speed −5 ft until a rest.
2	Brittle Bones	Joints & Bones	Falling or being knocked prone	Falls deal one extra damage die; standing up costs your Quick action.
3	Bad Back	Joints & Bones	Lifting, shoving, or carrying more than half your max load	Max load −2. Checks to lift or shove are at disadvantage.
4	Trick Shoulder	Joints & Bones	Your first two-handed or thrown attack each fight	On a natural 1-3 the shoulder pops out; lose your next Quick action.
5	Gout Foot	Joints & Bones	A day of rich food in town, or a forced march	Speed −5 ft for the next day, and stealth checks at disadvantage from the limp.
6	Arthritic Hands	Joints & Bones	Fine work in cold or damp places	Disadvantage on tool and lockpick checks. Drawing a weapon costs your Movement instead of a Quick action.
7	Stiff Mornings	Joints & Bones	First combat after a long rest	You lose your Quick action in the first round.
8	Creaky Joints	Joints & Bones	Sneaking in armor or over old floors	Stealth at disadvantage. On a failure the GM rolls a travel turn immediately.
9	Weak Ankle	Joints & Bones	Moving through difficult terrain in combat	DC 11 DEX check or fall prone.
10	Rain-Hip	Joints & Bones	Weather about to turn	You always know a storm is coming within a day, but the day it arrives your speed is −5 ft.
11	Bent Fingers	Joints & Bones	Fighting with a dagger or other small weapon	Damage −1 with that weapon.
12	Can't Kneel	Joints & Bones	Searching low, crawling, or praying at an altar	It takes twice as long, and crawling counts as harsh terrain.
13	Failing Eyes	Senses	Ranged attack beyond short range, or reading by torchlight	Disadvantage.
14	Hard of Hearing	Senses	Listening at doors, hearing whispers, sound-based perception	Disadvantage. The GM may feed you a misheard version.
15	Night Blindness	Senses	Anything beyond 15 ft of a light source	Treat dim light as darkness.
16	No Sense of Smell	Senses	Gas, rot, smoke, or poison in food	The GM never gives you scent cues. You have advantage against stench and nausea effects.
17	Ringing Ears	Senses	Any loud blast, roar, or thunder	Disadvantage on listening checks until your next rest.
18	One Good Eye	Senses	Being flanked	Once per session the GM can let an enemy strike from your blind side with advantage.
19	Squinter	Senses	Brilliant light, snow glare, or magical flashes	Disadvantage on sight checks and attacks in brilliant light.
20	Dull Tongue	Senses	Tasting potions, spoiled rations, or a suspicious drink	Identifying anything by taste automatically fails.

d100	Ailment	Category	Trigger	Effect
21	Numb Fingertips	Senses	Searching by touch, picking pockets, feeling for traps in the dark	Disadvantage.
22	Colors Muddled	Senses	Telling apart colored runes, gems, banners, or potions	Once per session the GM may describe the wrong color to you.
23	Torch-Dazzled	Senses	Each time a torch or lantern is lit near you	Disadvantage on your next attack.
24	Spectacles	Senses	Any natural 1 on a physical check, or an enemy crit against you	The spectacles break (DUR 1). Until repaired you have Failing Eyes.
25	Winded	Wind & Stamina	Sprinting, or a second combat without a short rest	DC 12 CON check or you can't Move this round.
26	Wheezy Lungs	Wind & Stamina	Smoke, dust, or freezing air	DC 11 CON check or you lose your Active action to coughing.
27	Loud Cough	Wind & Stamina	The party is hidden	Once per session the GM can let your cough break the party's stealth.
28	Tires Fast	Wind & Stamina	Long travel	Your resilience counts as CON −3.
29	Racing Heart	Wind & Stamina	The first time each session you drop below half HP	Lose your next Movement action while you catch your breath.
30	Needs a Nap	Wind & Stamina	Afternoons	Unless you rest an hour by midday, disadvantage on INT and WIS checks until nightfall.
31	Cold Bones	Wind & Stamina	Cold weather, deep water, or night watch outdoors	Lose 1 extra resilience each hour.
32	Heat Sweats	Wind & Stamina	Hot places, or heavy armor for more than an hour	Lose 1 extra resilience each hour. Heavy armor counts as 6 load for you.
33	Slow Healer	Wind & Stamina	Healing from rest	Heal 1 HP fewer per night of safe rest (minimum 1).
34	Light Sleeper	Wind & Stamina	Resting in unsafe places	You are never surprised in camp, but you heal no HP from unsafe rest.
35	Heavy Sleeper	Wind & Stamina	An alarm or ambush while you sleep	DC 13 WIS check to wake, or you sleep through the first round.
36	Delicate Stomach	Wind & Stamina	Rough rations, foreign food, or swamp water	DC 11 CON check or lose 2 resilience.
37	Seasick	Wind & Stamina	Boats, flying mounts, or swaying bridges	Disadvantage on all checks while aboard and for an hour after.
38	Forgetful	Memory & Mind	Once per session, at the GM's call	You forgot one mundane item: spend 1 SUP or do without it.
39	Names Escape You	Memory & Mind	Meeting or greeting NPCs	You use the wrong name. −2 on your first reaction roll with any new NPC.
40	Outdated Map	Memory & Mind	Navigating somewhere you knew decades ago	You remember it as it was. The GM gives you one wrong detail.
41	Repeats Himself	Memory & Mind	Planning or briefing the party	The plan takes twice as long; the GM may advance a travel turn.
42	Half-Remembered Incantations	Memory & Mind	Your first cast of each spell level per session	+1 to that spellcasting DC.
43	Where Are My Keys	Memory & Mind	Fetching a specific item from your pack in combat	It costs your Movement instead of a Quick action.

d100	Ailment	Category	Trigger	Effect
44	Lost Track of Time	Memory & Mind	Hours passing underground	You only notice your torch has died when it goes out. Spend 1 extra SUP of torches per day.
45	Old Instincts	Memory & Mind	Hearing a command or bugle call from your old war	DC 11 WIS check or you obey it at once.
46	Tunnel Focus	Memory & Mind	Fighting more than one enemy	Enemies flanking you have advantage.
47	Daydreamer	Memory & Mind	Long journeys and night watches	Disadvantage on perception during travel turns.
48	Baffled by New Coin	Memory & Mind	Buying, selling, or haggling	You overpay by 10% unless you spend an hour counting.
49	Ledger of Grudges	Memory & Mind	Dealing with a faction that wronged you	Disadvantage on all social checks with them.
50	Can't Read Small Print	Memory & Mind	Reading scrolls, maps, or contracts below well-lit conditions	Scroll casting checks at disadvantage; you miss one clause in any contract.
51	Set in Your Ways	Temperament	Persuading anyone young, new, or modern	Disadvantage, but advantage on Intimidate against the same people.
52	War Stories	Temperament	You start telling one (player's choice)	CHA vs DC 12. Pass: one ally gets advantage on their next check. Fail: a torch burns down one extra turn.
53	Night Terrors	Temperament	Short rest in a dungeon	DC 12 WIS check or you regain no HP from that rest.
54	Short Fuse	Temperament	Being insulted or doubted	DC 11 WIS check or you make a scene. Reactions from that group –2.
55	Grumpy Before Breakfast	Temperament	The first hour after waking	Disadvantage on CHA checks.
56	Won't Retreat	Temperament	The party retreats or flees	DC 11 WIS check to go with them; on a failure you hold the line one more round.
57	Stubborn Pride	Temperament	Being offered help or healing	You refuse the first offer each session. Accepting it anyway costs a Grit token.
58	Worrier	Temperament	A fight you saw coming	Advantage to spot ambushes, but you start the fight without a Quick action from fussing.
59	Soft Heart	Temperament	The weak or young in danger	You must try to help them, whatever it costs the plan.
60	Bitter Rival	Temperament	Once per adventure	The GM brings your old rival into the story at the worst moment.
61	Paranoid	Temperament	Accepting food, deals, or gifts	Disadvantage on CHA checks while you inspect everything, but the first poisoned drink each adventure never fools you.
62	Nostalgic	Temperament	Seeing a relic or place from the old days	You lose your Movement the first round you see it while you reminisce.
63	Backseat Commander	Temperament	Watching a younger ally make a mistake	You correct them out loud. The party's stealth that round is at disadvantage.
64	Haunted by the Fallen	Temperament	Seeing undead or open graves	DC 11 WIS check or disadvantage on attacks against undead for one round.

d100	Ailment	Category	Trigger	Effect
65	Superstitious	Temperament	Breaking an omen: spilled salt, a black cat, the 13th step	Disadvantage on your next check until you spend a minute on a warding ritual.
66	Pipe Smoker	Habits & Vices	Four hours without a smoke	Disadvantage on WIS checks. Smoking costs 1 SUP a day and leaves a trail beasts can follow.
67	Fond of Drink	Habits & Vices	A tavern night or a celebration	DC 12 CON check or disadvantage on all checks until midday.
68	Snores	Habits & Vices	Camping outdoors	Travel turns rolled during your sleep are at disadvantage.
69	Collector	Habits & Vices	Finding trinkets in a dungeon	You must pocket one useless curio per dungeon. +1 load each.
70	Ration Hoarder	Habits & Vices	Packing for an adventure	Max SUP is INT −2, but once per adventure you produce a free day of rations.
71	Talks to Himself	Habits & Vices	Sneaking alone	Disadvantage on solo stealth checks.
72	Must Have Tea	Habits & Vices	Each morning	Spend 1 SUP on tea or take disadvantage on your first check of the day.
73	Fidgets	Habits & Vices	Staying hidden for more than a minute	DC 11 WIS check or you give yourself away.
74	Gambler	Habits & Vices	Dice, cards, or a wager nearby	You must bet. Lose 1d20 gp unless you pass a DC 12 CHA check.
75	Early to Bed	Habits & Vices	Anything after midnight	Disadvantage on all checks.
76	Hums Marching Songs	Habits & Vices	Quiet moments	Once per session the GM can spoil the party's stealth. Retainers you lead have advantage on morale.
77	Overpacker	Habits & Vices	Leaving town	You start every adventure with 2 extra load of things you insist you need.
78	Old Wound	Old Scars & Curses	An enemy scores a critical hit on you	Take an extra 1d4 damage as the old scar tears.
79	Shaky Hands	Old Scars & Curses	Spellcasting check, lockpicking, or disarming a trap	Fail by 1 or 2 and it counts as a full failure; for casters, a mishap.
80	Arrowhead Still In	Old Scars & Curses	Cold weather or wearing heavy armor	The first hit you take each fight deals +1 damage.
81	Dragonfire Scars	Old Scars & Curses	Taking fire damage	+2 fire damage taken, but advantage to resist fear from dragons.
82	Lich's Mark	Old Scars & Curses	Undead within 30 ft	They always know where you are. You can't hide from undead.
83	Echo of a Cursed Blade	Old Scars & Curses	Rolling a natural 20 on an attack	DC 11 WIS check or the old curse smothers it: normal damage instead of double.
84	Missing Fingers	Old Scars & Curses	Two-handed grips and fine tool work	Disadvantage on tool checks. You can't dual-wield.
85	Wooden Leg	Old Scars & Curses	Swimming, climbing, or chases	Disadvantage, and your speed is 25 ft. You can't be tripped by that leg.
86	Faded Holy Tattoo	Old Scars & Curses	Divine healing cast on you	You heal half the amount. The old god holds a grudge.
87	Glass Jaw	Old Scars & Curses	A critical hit against you	DC 11 CON check or lose your next turn, dazed.

d100	Ailment	Category	Trigger	Effect
88	Poison Never Left	Old Scars & Curses	Checks against poison, venom, or disease	Disadvantage on those CON checks.
89	Fey Debt Overdue	Old Scars & Curses	Full-moon nights	Once per adventure a fey creditor appears to collect, in coin or in favors.
90	Spell-Burned Nerves	Old Scars & Curses	Being targeted by an arcane spell	Disadvantage to resist it, but you feel any magic within 10 ft.
91	Stitched Belly	Old Scars & Curses	Heavy lifting or being grappled	DC 11 CON check or take 1d4 damage as the stitches pull.
92	Old Debts	Reputation & Society	Entering any town	The GM rolls 1d6; on a 1 a creditor finds you.
93	Wanted, Long Ago	Reputation & Society	Meeting guards or officials	If they know your renown, their reaction roll is -4.
94	Living Legend	Reputation & Society	Anywhere public	You can't go unnoticed. Disguise and blending-in checks at disadvantage.
95	Outlived Your Friends	Reputation & Society	Leading retainers and hench	Max hench -1. When a retainer dies, the rest roll morale at disadvantage.
96	Estranged Family	Reputation & Society	Once per adventure	A relative turns up needing something from you, right now.
97	Tall Tales	Reputation & Society	Persuading anyone who has heard of you	Disadvantage; they assume you're exaggerating.
98	Pension Owed	Reputation & Society	Passing through your old lord's lands	You must press your claim, and lose a day to clerks each time.
99	Out of Fashion	Reputation & Society	Courts and high society	Disadvantage on CHA checks with nobles; your gear marks you as an antique.
100	Retired Twice Already	Reputation & Society	Hiring retainers	They expect you to quit again and demand double pay up front.

Remedies and Wisdom of Age

Remedies suppress an ailment for one adventure at a cost; Wisdom of Age gives every veteran one edge the young don't have.

Remedies (downtime, between adventures)

- Pay 25 gp for a tonic, brace, spectacles, or ear trumpet. One chosen ailment is suppressed until the end of the next adventure.
- The remedy can break or run out at the GM's call, once, during a dramatic moment.
- Doubles as a gold sink for veterans who start broke.

Wisdom of Age (pick one at creation)

Category	Boon	Rule
Battle-Wise	Dirty Fighting	Once per combat, impose disadvantage on an enemy's attack with a trick you learned the hard way.
Battle-Wise	Patient Strike	If you hold your action for a full round in a fight, your next attack has advantage.
Battle-Wise	Know When to Run	Advantage on retreat and chase checks when you are the one fleeing.
Battle-Wise	Shield-Wall Habit	While you stand next to an ally, you both get +1 AC.
Battle-Wise	Pick the Leader	Once per fight, point out the enemy leader. Allies have advantage on their first attack against it.
Battle-Wise	Old Footwork	Once per fight, step out of melee without any enemy getting an attack on you.
Battle-Wise	Measured Breath	Once per session, turn one missed attack into a hit for half damage.
Battle-Wise	Battlefield Eye	In a fight you saw coming, you act first in the first round regardless of DEX.

Category	Boon	Rule
Battle-Wise	Disarm	Once per fight, on a hit, knock the enemy's weapon away instead of dealing damage.
Battle-Wise	Second Wind	Once per session, when you drop below half HP, recover HP equal to your level as a Quick action.
Road-Wise	Pace Yourself	Your torch and supply use count as one step lower on the first day of an expedition.
Road-Wise	Old Soldier's Pack	Once per adventure, declare you packed one mundane item you never listed. You still pay its SUP.
Road-Wise	Weather Nose	Each morning the GM tells you the day's weather truthfully.
Road-Wise	Camp Craft	When you set up camp, everyone heals 1 extra HP from unsafe rest.
Road-Wise	Trail Memory	When the party rolls to return along a route you walked, everyone rolls with advantage.
Road-Wise	Forager's Eye	Advantage on foraging checks.
Road-Wise	Torch Discipline	Once per day, a torch you light burns for 2 hours instead of 1.
Road-Wise	Iron Gut	Rotten, strange, or foreign food never costs you resilience.
Road-Wise	Ration Stretcher	Once per adventure, one day of your rations feeds the whole party.
Road-Wise	Road-Hardened	Your resilience is CON +2.
Worldly	Old Contacts	Once per adventure, name a contact from your past in this town. The GM decides how happy they are to see you.
Worldly	Read the Room	Once per session, ask the GM how one NPC truly feels about you; the GM tells you their reaction result.
Worldly	Haggler	You buy at 10% less and sell at 10% more.
Worldly	Known Face	Once per session, the GM rolls your renown with advantage, and that NPC's reaction can't be worse than cautious.
Worldly	Tavern Ears	An evening in a tavern gets you one true rumor about your current goal.
Worldly	Old Pardon	Once per campaign, a lord who owes you drops one charge against you or an ally.
Worldly	Courtly Manners	Advantage on CHA checks with nobles and officials.
Worldly	Calm Voice	Once per session, before blades are drawn, raise an NPC's reaction by one step.
Worldly	Lingua Franca	You speak a smattering of every common tongue; simple talk needs no check.
Worldly	Teacher	Once per session, lend an ally your proficiency bonus on one check they aren't proficient in.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Seen It Before	Once per session, ask the GM one true question about a monster, trap, or ruin.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Trap Sense	You get a check to spot every trap the GM forewarns, even when you didn't say you were searching.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Monster Lore	Once per session, name one weakness of a creature you've fought before; the GM confirms or corrects you.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Old Maps	Once per adventure, you once saw a map of this place: the GM sketches one area for you.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Rune-Reader	Advantage on checks to identify magic items and read old scripts.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Poison Taster	You recognize any common poison by sight or smell, and have advantage on CON checks against poison.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Field Surgeon	Stabilizing an ally needs no check, and they roll on the Injury Table with advantage.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Mishap Memory	Once per session, when a spellcasting mishap happens near you, have it rerolled on the Magical Mishap Table.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Undead Hunter	Advantage on attacks against undead in the first round of a fight.
Hard-Won Knowledge	Siege Sense	You spot the weak point of any wall, door, or structure; breaking through takes half the time.
Grit & Spirit	Unbreakable	Once per session, when you would drop to 0 HP, drop to 1 instead.
Grit & Spirit	Steady Nerves	Advantage against fear effects.

Category	Boon	Rule
Grit & Spirit	Stubborn Mind	Advantage against charm and mind control.
Grit & Spirit	Last Stand	While you are the only one in the party still standing, all your checks have advantage.
Grit & Spirit	Spite	When an ally drops near you, your next attack deals +1d6 damage.
Grit & Spirit	Gallows Humor	Once per session, a joke at the worst moment gives one ally a Grit token.
Grit & Spirit	Old Prayers	Once per session, reroll a failed resilience check.
Grit & Spirit	Sentinel	You can't be surprised while you keep watch.
Grit & Spirit	Mentor's Voice	Retainers you lead have advantage on morale checks.
Grit & Spirit	One More Day	Once per adventure, ignore exhaustion for one full day.

GM notes and tuning

The main risk is ailments that fire too often and turn into a disadvantage tax; keep them occasional and always paid back with Grit.

- **Watch frequency:** if an ailment triggers more than twice a session, narrow its trigger. Bad Knee and Failing Eyes are the likeliest offenders.
- **Monsters:** level 9 parties in FTD hit hard. Use FTD's 5e conversion (half HP) but scale up numbers, not stat blocks, to keep 2-hour sessions moving.
- **Spell ceiling:** FTD caps spells at 5th level, so level 9 casters are within normal limits.
- **Session zero:** have each player tell one war story tied to their legend. Use those stories as hooks for the first adventure.
- **Playtest first:** run one session, then cut any ailment nobody enjoyed. Rename or rewrite freely.